



3.5mn year-old bear found

Remains of a small bear were found in a fossil site in the high arctic. It was observed that the bear had cavities, suggesting diet rich in sugars. <http://digit.in/OldBearLives>



Watch CRISPR edit genes

For the first time, scientists can see CRISPR's molecular scissors cut DNA in real-time <http://digit.in/CRISPRLive>



SOCIAL MEDIA ESPIONAGE

Your activity on social media is a goldmine for various entities to realise their own objectives

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verybody who's anybody is using a social media platform. If anything, nowadays it's almost mandatory to be on some social media platform or the other because of various reasons. For one thing, it's convenient. One place to keep track of all your friends, be aware of events around you, and some even use social media as their primary source of news. Another attractive attribute of these platforms is the reward mechanism associated with getting reactions from your near and dear ones after posting updates. On the flip side of the coin there are the more serious uses of social media. Some jobs require you to be on them, and others track your social media profiles as a means of evaluation. You could actually not get

that job you wanted if your employers aren't happy with that last post you just had to share.

But we're digressing. The point is – just about anybody with access to a computing device and the internet, is on social media. So many billions of users in a single space constantly updating the world with their day-to-day activities. We're sure you can already see why this is incredibly convenient for governments and other tracking organisations. As of the end of 2017, Facebook had a whopping 2.07 billion monthly active users, and that's just Facebook.

TRACKING ON STEROIDS

Your social media accounts and online trackers record every aspect of your life, your conversations, your purchases, your photos. People who

frequently upload photos are literally telling the world exactly where they are at that particular time. Everything you do leaves behind a trail of data which governments and other organisations are keen to lap up - especially due to its enormous potential and ready availability for various use cases. Thanks to this continuous stream of data everybody generates all the time, it is incredibly easy for organisations to keep track of people at large.

Now you may be wondering, aren't there privacy laws in place to prevent organisations from tracking you? Well, you're right. There are. In most parts of the world anyway. However, that doesn't stop most organisations from secretly gathering insane amounts of data from social media anyway. Just look at the Snowden NSA leaks. One of the revelations made by Snowden was